



Security Watch

A Little IE7 Bug

The Problem

A minor vulnerability has been discovered in Internet Explorer 7. We say "minor" because security firm Secunia has given it a rating of 2 on a scale of 5, which they call "less critical." The vulnerability can be exploited by bad people to conduct phishing attacks. We're assuming that IE7's phishing warning will not pop up if and when it happens.

Technically, a certain "input validation error" can be exploited to inject arbitrary script code to, for example, spoof the contents of an arbitrary site when you click the "Refresh page" link.

The vulnerability has been reported on IE7 on fully-patched Windows XP SP2 systems, though other versions, too, could be affected.

The Solution

There are two things to do. First, visit <http://tinyurl.com/2owakw> to see if your system is affected. If it is, don't click the "Refresh page" link when the "Navigation Canceled" page is displayed. No patch had been released at the time of writing.

Mac OS X: A ton of vulnerabilities

This is probably the first time a Mac vulnerability—rather, almost 30 of them—has been in the news in a big way. All you Mac owners out there will probably be aware of the security updates that have just been released, but just in case you aren't, do visit www.apple.com/support/downloads. You'll find all the necessary updates for your system.

increasing suicide attempts and an overall higher percentage of students suffering from depression that stems from loneliness, can you argue with him?

The solution will be to cut off Internet access to hostels from 11 in the night through to 12:30 pm the next day. IIT Bombay feels this will force students to sleep early, or at least interact with each other more. Students, on the other hand, feel that this is just another case of the authorities trying to govern their lives, and an infringement on their freedom to choose. With the other IITs also considering such moves, those who didn't get through the IIT JEE can look at the bright side—at least you still have the freedom to be addicted to the Net!

NUMB3RS

Most Internet Fraud Comes From US

Now we're used to news about the US government ordering other countries to take down pirate servers... remember The Pirate Bay fiasco? CEOs of various software companies in the US have chided Asians for high piracy rates. Asians have developed notoriety for being the source of quite a

few destructive viruses, while east-Europeans are known to run the best illegal torrent servers...

However, and we'll take a big pause here, it's the US itself that's to blame for the majority of scams and hacks being pulled online. China, obviously, is in second place, but it is a distant second.

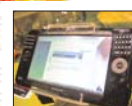
Security firm Symantec recently unveiled these findings, in the form of their Internet Security Threat Report.

To give you the numbers: 31 per cent of all malicious activity originates from US networks, and only 10 per cent from Chinese networks. Germany, surprisingly, is in third place on this list of shame with 7 per cent! France, the UK, South Korea are next with 4 per cent each, and Canada, Spain, Taiwan and Italy follow with 3 per cent each.

That's not all, according to the study, 51 per cent of all credit information sold illegally online is done so from US-based servers. The report also says that 52 per cent of all DoS attacks are targeted at US-based servers or computers, so the Americans really are getting the best and worst of everything Net-threat related.

A little unrelated, but fun fact nonetheless is the finding that 77 per cent of all browser attacks were against Microsoft's Internet Explorer. The study also reveals that China has the

HOT UMPCs



Everyone's trying to sell you one - run Windows XP or even

Vista on the go, connect to the Internet using a billion wireless protocols, and all else that you'd want to do with a PC on the go.

So Many Problems

Those little keyboards? Not for human-sized fingers. Battery life is hardly impressive (though thankfully getting better), and those touchscreens are just begging for fingerprints! On the usability chart, there's a lot to be desired.



most bot-infected computers, at 26 per cent. So this proves that the Chinese are the worst PC-security-conscious nation, but what's even more interesting is the fact that most of the bot-control PCs are located in the US (40 per cent). Conspiracy theorists in China must be pulling hair out by the clumps!

For those who don't understand the term bot-infected, it means a PC that has been compromised by a Trojan or worm, giving an unauthorised user access to the system via the Net. Bot-control PCs are the PCs used by the same unauthorised users to gain access to the infected PC. So basically, a lot of Americans are illegally controlling a



One Silly Question

"If Lalu were the chairman of Microsoft, what would Windows be called?"



"Bihari"
Brijou Gandhi



"Chhutkan Khidki"
Juthika Mehta



"Yadhav Small"
Maitri Mehta



"Jai Rabadi Devi"
Payal Mody



"Laluwindows"
Vishakha Shah